MZUZU UNIVERSITY

FACULTY OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES

DEPARTMENT OF COMMUNICATION STUDIES

END OF SEMESTER EXAMINATIONS – FEBRUARY 2019

COMM 1101: COMMUNICATION SKILLS I

DATE: Wednesday, February 13, 2019 **TIME: 2Hrs 30 Minutes**

Instructions: Answer **all** questions

Write the name of your **lecturer** on top of your answer book.

QUESTION 1.

A. Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

He was afraid that he was late. It was bad to be late to a Solidarity Service. He was afraid that the president would be angry.

He opened the door. Thank Ford! He was not the last to arrive. He sat in one of the empty chairs round the circular table. He hopped to escape attention.

The girl next to him asked, 'What were you playing this afternoon? Golf or tennis?' 'I wasn't playing either of them,' Bernard answered. She was astonished and turned away from Bernard. There was a tall, good-looking man on her other side.

'A good beginning for a Solidarity Service,' Bernard thought miserably. He knew that he was not going to enjoy himself. Once again he would fail. He could never share in the experiences of his companions. The president stood up. The music began. *Soma* was blessed and passed round. Each worshipper swallowed the sacred food. Drums beat.

The *soma* began to work. Eyes shone. Faces smiled. A deep Voice spoke: 'Oh, Ford, Ford, Ford.'

'Ford!' the group answered. 'Ford is coming.' The drums beat louder. Round they went in the dance. They moved to the rhythmic beat of the drums: 'Ford-Ford; Ford, Ford, Ford,' quicker and quicker.

The music played the Orgy-porgy song. The dancers sang it:

Orgy-porgy, Ford and fun,

Kiss the girls and make them One.

Boys at one with girls at peace;

Orgy-porgy gives release.

Darker and darker grew the room. Quicker and quicker went the dance. Only a faint red light lit the faces of the group. Their excitement. 'Orgy-porgy; Orgy-porgy,' they shouted. The

drum beat stopped. The deep Voice whispered, 'Orgy-porgy- *now*.' The circle of dancers broke up.

Later-much later-they were standing on the roof. The night was calm and warm. 'Wasn't it wonderful?' said Fifi Bradlaugh. 'Wasn't it wonderful?' She looked at Bernard. Her face was peaceful. The Solidarity Service had filled her with deep joy. She was made perfect. 'Everyone belongs to everyone else.'

'Did you think it was wonderful?' she repeated. Her eyes were shining with the delight of 'togetherness'.

'Yes, I thought it was wonderful,' Bernard lied. Then he looked away. He was as miserable and as lonely as he had been when the service began. The happiness of the other members of the group made his own misery worse.

They belonged to each other. *He* belonged to nobody. They were at peace with themselves and the System. He was at war with himself; and he could not find happiness in the system. Was it his own fault? Or was the fault in the System? 'Alone; always alone,' he thought sadly. 'What is wrong with me? Why am I different?'

But aloud he said to Fifi Bradlaugh, 'Quite wonderful'. Then he walked away from his happy companions.

Questions

i. Write down two games said to have been played by people according to this story. **(2 marks)**

ii. Why did the faces of the people smile for a while as explained in this story? **(2 marks)**

iii. What do the following words or expressions mean as used in the story?

a). astonished **(1 mark)**

b). soma **(1 mark)**

d). broke up **(1 mark)**

f). standing on the roof **(1 mark)**

g). everyone belongs to everyone **(2 marks)**

e). the delight of togetherness **(2 mark)**

vi. Provide a suitable title for this story. **(2 marks)**

B. How would you utilise the following reading strategies to enhance your academic performance while pursuing your studies in this university:

i. Intensive reading **(3 marks)**

ii. Prediction reading **(3 marks)**

QUESTION 2

A. When using the APA style of referencing one needs to use citations and create a reference list. Briefly explain the difference between the two? **(4marks)**

B. **Read the following text and write a summary on it:**

> Researchers in France and the United States have recently reported that baboons are able to think abstractly. It has been known for some time that chimpanzees are capable of abstract thought, but baboons are a more distant relation to mankind. In the experiment, scientists trained two baboons to use a personal computer and a joystick. The animals had to match computer designs which were basically the same, but had superficial differences. In the experiment the baboons performed better than would be expected by chance. The researchers describe their study in an article in the Journal of Experimental Psychology. **(5marks)**

C. Study the information below and compile it into entries as they would appear in a reference list:

i. Macmillan Education Ltd;pp100-135; managerial economics; Hill S; The analysis of business decisions; London;2004. **(6marks)**

ii. Code of ethics and professional conduct, Media Council of Malawi; Blantyre; 1995; Dzuka Publishers. **(5marks)**

QUESTION 3

A. State any **four** disadvantages of ignoring the use of timetables in a university. **(4 marks)**

B. Briefly explain any **two** conditions that could positively affect the study environment. **(4 marks)**

C. How can friends affect your studies negatively? **(2 marks)**

QUESTION 4

A. Explain any **two** differences between Mathematical and Interactional models of communication. **(4 marks)**

B. Using any **one** example, explain non-verbal communication. **(3 marks)**

C. In the communication process, noise is an element that interferes with the clarity of the message. With any **one** example explain psychological noise. **(3 marks)**

END OF QUESTION PAPER